



09 | Building Bridges: Mutual Understanding



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9.1 How to Collaborate With Me:

- Be upfront. I respect honesty even when it's messy.
- Clarify if I misinterpret — I don't mind being corrected.
- Be curious. Ask questions. Assume good intentions.

If we build understanding from both ends, we both win.



Based on Cody's manual, their collaborative style reflects a thoughtful approach shaped by their intersecting identities:

Direct Communication Preference:

- Values upfront honesty, even when conversations are messy or imperfect. This likely stems from experiences where clear communication helps avoid misunderstandings that can be particularly challenging for someone who is both neurodivergent and transgender.

Open to Correction:

- Explicitly welcomes clarification when misinterpretations occur. This shows awareness of how ADHD and neurodivergent processing might affect their understanding of situations.

Emphasis on Mutual Understanding:

- Encourages curiosity and questions while assuming good intentions. This approach helps create a safe space for authentic interaction, particularly important for someone navigating multiple marginalized identities.

Collaborative Growth:

- Believes in mutual benefit through shared understanding. This perspective suggests a desire for genuine connection while maintaining boundaries necessary for managing PTSD and neurodivergent needs.